

— CLIENT HANDBOOK · 2026

Microsoft 365 Business

A complete guide to your new business email, cloud storage and productivity platform.

— CONTENTS

What is in this guide

Nineteen pages. Read it front to back once, then keep it for the pages you need again.

GETTING STARTED

Introduction	03
Your dashboard	04

EMAIL

Outlook	05
Shared mailboxes	06
Who can see what	07

YOUR APPLICATIONS

OneDrive	08
Word	09
Excel	10
PowerPoint	11
Teams	12
SharePoint	13
OneNote and Bookings	14
Copilot	15

RUNNING IT WELL

Security	16
Signing in	17
Best practices	18
Support	19

— INTRODUCTION

Your business is now on Microsoft 365

Email on your own domain, files that cannot be lost with a laptop, and the Office applications you already know, all reached from one sign in.

Every Leikah email address now runs on Microsoft 365 Business, the same platform used by the mines and contractors you invoice. Mail arrives at `leikahgroup.co.za` rather than a free personal account, which is the single clearest signal to a client that they are dealing with a real company.

The setup has been completed, tested and verified. Mail sends and receives, the sender authentication records are published on your domain so your messages are trusted rather than filtered to junk, and each person has been given access to exactly the mailboxes their role needs.

What the platform gives you

COMMUNICATION

- Business email on your own domain
- Shared mailboxes for departments
- Calendars and meeting invitations
- Chat and video meetings in Teams

SECURITY

- Secure sign in with verification
- Spam and phishing filtering
- Central control of who sees what
- Access removed instantly when staff leave

FILES AND DOCUMENTS

- Cloud storage that backs itself up
- Word, Excel and PowerPoint online
- Shared company document libraries
- File sharing by link, not attachment

CONTINUITY

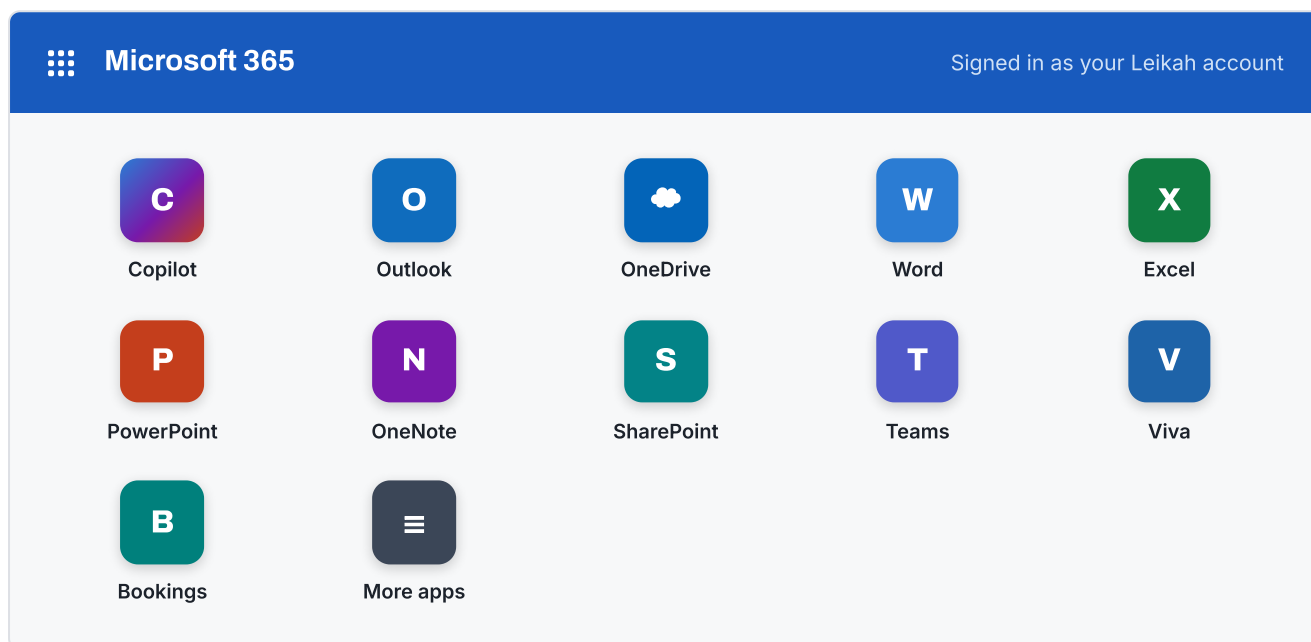
- Nothing lives on one person's laptop
- Deleted mail and files are recoverable
- Department mail survives staff changes
- Works from office, site or phone

READ FIRST The rest of this guide walks through every application on your dashboard, one section each, and explains what it is for in the context of a plant hire and heavy mechanical business rather than in general terms.

— YOUR DASHBOARD

Everything from one place

Sign in once at microsoft365.com and every application you own appears behind the grid of nine dots in the top left corner. That grid is called the app launcher.



HOW TO OPEN AN APPLICATION

Click the nine dot grid in the top left of any Microsoft page, then click the application you want. It opens in your browser. Nothing needs to be installed.

MOVING BETWEEN APPLICATIONS

The grid is always in the same place, inside every application. You never have to go back to the start page to switch from Outlook to Excel.

TIP

Bookmark microsoft365.com and nothing else. It is the front door to all of it. Bookmarking Outlook on its own is the most common reason people think they only have email.



Outlook

Business email, calendar and contacts

Where every message to and from Leikah arrives. It also holds the company calendar, so a machine handover, a site visit and a workshop booking can all sit in one place that other staff can see.

WHAT YOU USE IT FOR

- Sending and receiving company email
- Reading the department mailboxes you belong to
- Booking meetings and sending invitations
- Keeping client and supplier contacts
- Finding an old message by searching

FOLDERS

Make a folder per client or per site and drag mail into it. Right click **Folders** in the left panel, then **Create new folder**. A mailbox with folders stays usable after a thousand messages. One without does not.

The calendar

Click the calendar icon in the left rail. Create an appointment, add the client's email address under **Invite attendees**, and they receive a proper meeting invitation that lands in their own calendar. For a site visit or a machine inspection this looks considerably more organised than confirming by message.

TYPICAL DAY AT LEIKAH

- A hire enquiry lands in `sales@`
- A purchase order lands in `accounts@`
- A breakdown call is followed up from `info@`
- A site meeting is put in the calendar and the client is invited

SEARCHING

The search bar at the top searches every mailbox you can see. Type a client name, a machine model or an invoice number. This is faster than any filing system, so search before you scroll.

TIP

Install the **Outlook** app on your phone and add your Leikah address. Without it you only see mail when you open a browser, and a breakdown enquiry can sit unread for hours.

— IMPORTANT

Shared mailboxes

Four of your addresses belong to the company rather than to a person. They are the reason an enquiry never sits unanswered because one employee is on leave.

A shared mailbox has no password of its own and nobody logs into it. Instead, named staff are given access, and the mailbox simply appears in their own Outlook underneath their personal mail. Everyone who has access sees the same messages, and a reply sent by one person is visible to all of them.

Your four shared mailboxes

ADDRESS	APPEARS AS	WHAT IT HANDLES
info@	Leikah Plant Hire	General enquiries, breakdown dispatch, workshop
sales@	Leikah Sales	Plant hire rates, availability, quotations
admin@	Leikah Admin	Supply, procurement, parts and consumables
accounts@	Leikah Accounts	Purchase orders, invoicing, vendor packs

How to reply from a shared mailbox

- 01 Open the message in the shared mailbox and click **Reply**.
- 02 Look at the **From** line above the message body. If it shows your own name, click it.
- 03 Choose the shared address, for example `sales@leikahgroup.co.za`.
- 04 Send. The client sees the reply as coming from Leikah Sales, not from you personally, and their answer returns to the same shared mailbox where the rest of the team can see it.

AVOID

Replying to a shared mailbox message from your own address. The client then has your personal address and every follow up goes to you alone, which undoes the entire point of a shared mailbox the moment you take leave.

WHY IT MATTERS

When a staff member leaves, the mailbox and its full history stay with the company. Nothing has to be handed over, forwarded or recovered.

— ACCESS

Who can see what

Access was set deliberately, not by default. Financial mail is separated from general enquiry mail so that front desk staff can be helpful without seeing your figures.

ACCOUNT	INFO@	SALES@	ADMIN@	ACCOUNTS@
Director	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Management	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Reception	Yes	Yes	Yes	No

WHAT RECEPTION CAN DO

- Read and reply to general enquiries
- Handle hire enquiries and pass them on
- Work with supply and procurement mail
- Send replies as Leikah rather than as themselves

WHAT RECEPTION CANNOT DO

- See invoices, purchase orders or vendor packs
- Open the administration centre
- Add or remove staff accounts
- Change who has access to a mailbox

Changing this later

Access is not fixed. A new staff member can be added to any mailbox, and a departing one can be removed from all of them in under a minute. Both are done centrally, which means there is nothing to uninstall from a laptop and no password to change in a hurry.

Contact ISM Digital Solutions with the person's name, the address they need and the mailboxes they should see, and it will be set up for you.

TIP

Review this table whenever someone joins or leaves. The most common security gap in a small business is not a hacked password, it is a former employee who still has access.



OneDrive

Cloud storage and backup

Your own private storage in the cloud. A file saved here is on every device you sign into, and it survives a stolen laptop, a failed hard drive and a phone dropped in the yard.

WHAT YOU USE IT FOR

- Storing documents instead of on a desktop
- Reaching the same file from office and site
- Sending large files without email limits
- Recovering a file you deleted by mistake
- Going back to yesterday's version of a document

TYPICAL USES AT LEIKAH

- Machine photographs from an inspection
- Signed hire agreements and delivery notes
- Operator certificates and tickets
- Job costings in progress

Sharing a file

Right click the file, choose **Share**, and enter an email address or copy a link. The recipient opens the current version rather than a copy that goes stale the moment you edit yours. This matters most with a large set of site photographs, which most mail systems refuse to carry as attachments.

Recovering something

Deleted files sit in the **Recycle bin** in the left panel for thirty days. Beyond that, any file still in OneDrive can be rolled back to an earlier version: right click it and choose **Version history**. This is the difference between an overwritten quotation being a nuisance and being a lost afternoon.

HABIT

Save straight to OneDrive rather than to the desktop and then copying it across. A file that is only ever in one place is a file you will eventually lose.



Word

Documents and written correspondence

For anything that goes out on a letterhead. A document written in Word and sent as a PDF reads as a company document. The same words typed into an email do not.

WHAT YOU USE IT FOR

- Letters to clients and suppliers
- Company policies and procedures
- Hire terms and conditions
- Method statements and job reports
- Contracts and service agreements

TYPICAL USES AT LEIKAH

- A covering letter with a quotation
- A breakdown report after a call out
- A safety file document for a mine
- A letter of good standing for a vendor pack

Build templates once

Set up a document with the Leikah letterhead, address and contact details at the top, then save it in OneDrive as **Leikah letterhead**. Every time you need a letter, open it, choose **File** then **Save a copy**, and write into the copy. The original stays clean.

Do the same for anything you write more than twice: a hire agreement, a site report, a vendor cover letter.

TIP

Send documents as PDF, not as Word files. Choose **File**, then **Export**, then **Download as PDF**. A PDF cannot be edited by the recipient and looks identical on every device.



Excel

Numbers, schedules and tracking

The most useful application in the set for a plant hire business, because almost everything you need to control is a list with numbers attached to it.

WHAT YOU USE IT FOR

- Quotations and rate calculations
- Invoicing and statement tracking
- Equipment and fleet registers
- Maintenance and service schedules
- Budgets and job costings

FOUR REGISTERS WORTH KEEPING

- **Fleet:** machine, model, hours, location, status
- **Service:** machine, last service, hours due, next date
- **Hire:** client, machine, on hire date, rate, off hire
- **Costing:** job, fuel, parts, labour, total, invoiced

Why keep these in Excel rather than on paper

A fleet register in a book is read by one person in one office. The same register in Excel, saved in OneDrive, can be opened on a phone in the yard, updated by the workshop, and seen by the director without a phone call. Two people can even have it open at the same time and watch each other's changes appear.

TIP

Select your data and choose **Format as table**. You then get sorting and filtering on every column, which turns a service schedule into something you can instantly read as "what is due this month".



PowerPoint

Presentations and proposals

For the times you have to present Leikah rather than describe it. A capability presentation with photographs of your own fleet does more in five minutes than a rate sheet does in a week.

WHAT YOU USE IT FOR

- Company capability presentations
- Client proposals and tender presentations
- Toolbox talks and safety meetings
- Operator and workshop training
- A visual company profile

TYPICAL USES AT LEIKAH

- Introducing the fleet to a new mine client
- A monthly safety meeting for the yard
- Presenting a workshop rebuild capability
- A vendor introduction for procurement

Keep it plain

A capability presentation needs perhaps ten slides: who you are, where you are, what you run, what you repair, who you work for, how quickly you respond, and how to reach you. Put one photograph and one short heading on each. Long paragraphs on a screen are read by nobody in the room.

TIP

Export the presentation as a PDF before emailing it to a client. It keeps your layout exactly as you built it and opens on any phone without PowerPoint installed.



Teams

Internal chat and video meetings

Internal conversation that stays inside the business. Teams replaces the personal messaging groups that company discussion tends to end up in, where nobody who joins later can see the history.

WHAT YOU USE IT FOR

- Chat between staff, one to one or in a group
- Video meetings with staff or clients
- Screen sharing to show a document or a drawing
- Sharing files inside a conversation
- Calling a colleague without using airtime

CHANNELS WORTH CREATING

- **Workshop:** repairs in progress and parts needed
- **Hire desk:** machine movements and availability
- **Breakdowns:** live call outs and who is attending
- **General:** everything that affects everyone

Meeting a client on video

You can invite anyone to a Teams meeting, including people who do not have Microsoft 365. They click the link in the invitation and join from their browser with nothing to install. For a client three hours away who wants to discuss a rebuild, this saves a day of travel on both sides.

ADOPT LATER

Teams does not have to be introduced on day one. Start with email, and bring Teams in once the mailboxes are part of everyone's routine. It is included and will be waiting.



SharePoint

Company document library

Where company documents live, as opposed to personal ones. If OneDrive is your own filing cabinet, SharePoint is the company's, and it stays when people move on.

WHAT YOU USE IT FOR

- Shared folders every staff member can reach
- Documents that belong to the company, not a person
- Controlling who can edit and who can only read
- Keeping one master copy of a document

SUGGESTED LIBRARIES

- **Company:** registration, tax, B-BBEE, insurance
- **Fleet:** machine files, service history, manuals
- **Clients:** one folder per client
- **Templates:** letterheads, quotations, agreements

OneDrive or SharePoint

QUESTION

ANSWER

Is it your own working file?

OneDrive

Would a colleague need it if you were away?

SharePoint

Is it a company record?

SharePoint

Is it a draft nobody else should see yet?

OneDrive

TIP

Your compliance documents are the strongest case for SharePoint. When a mine asks for a vendor pack, everything should be in one folder that anyone at Leikah can reach, rather than on whichever laptop assembled it last time.



OneNote

Notes that do not get lost

A notebook that syncs between your phone and your computer. Useful precisely where paper fails, which is anywhere with dust, diesel or rain.

WHAT YOU USE IT FOR

- Meeting and site visit notes
- Job notes taken at a breakdown
- Inspection findings with photographs
- Parts to order, before they become an order

WHY IT BEATS A NOTEBOOK

- Notes taken on a phone are on your computer already
- You can search every note you have ever written
- A photograph can sit next to the note it belongs to
- Nothing is lost when the book is



Bookings

Appointment scheduling

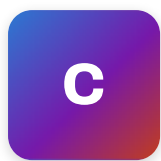
A booking page clients can use themselves. You set the hours you are available, they pick a slot, and it appears in your Outlook calendar with a confirmation sent automatically.

WHERE IT FITS AT LEIKAH

- Machine inspections before a hire
- Workshop assessment appointments
- Site meetings with a client
- Supplier and vendor consultations

WHAT IT SAVES YOU

- The back and forth of finding a time
- Double bookings in the workshop
- Missed appointments, because reminders are sent



Copilot

Microsoft's AI assistant

An assistant built into the Office applications. It can draft, summarise and explain, which removes most of the blank page problem from written work.

WHERE IT HELPS

- **Word:** drafting a letter or a report from a few notes
- **Outlook:** summarising a long message thread
- **Excel:** explaining a formula or building one for you
- **PowerPoint:** turning a document into slides

WHERE IT DOES NOT

- Anything where the facts must be exact
- Rates, hours, quantities and prices
- Compliance or contractual wording
- Anything sent out without being read first

LICENSING

The Copilot tile appears on every Microsoft 365 dashboard, but the version built into Word, Excel, Outlook and PowerPoint requires a separate paid licence per person, added on top of your current subscription. Clicking the tile without that licence gives you the general web assistant rather than the in application one.

ADVICE

Do not buy Copilot licences yet. Get the whole team using email, OneDrive and the calendar properly first. Copilot is worth adding once there is enough company material in the system for it to be useful, and it can be switched on for one person to trial.

— SECURITY

Keeping the business safe

Company email is the most common way a small business loses money. Not through a dramatic attack, but through a convincing message that changes banking details on an invoice.

Multi factor authentication

When you sign in, Microsoft asks for your password and then for a second confirmation on your phone. It takes three seconds and it is the single most effective protection you have, because a stolen password on its own becomes useless.

Approve a sign in only when you are the person signing in. If a prompt arrives while you are doing nothing, decline it and change your password, because somebody has your password and is trying it.

Recognising a phishing email

WARNING SIGNS

- Urgency, or a threat of something being cut off
- A sender address that is nearly right but not quite
- A link that asks you to sign in again
- An unexpected invoice or delivery notice
- A supplier's banking details that have changed

WHAT TO DO

- Do not click. Do not reply.
- Check the sender's full address, not the display name
- Phone the supplier on a number you already had
- Report it to ISM Digital Solutions

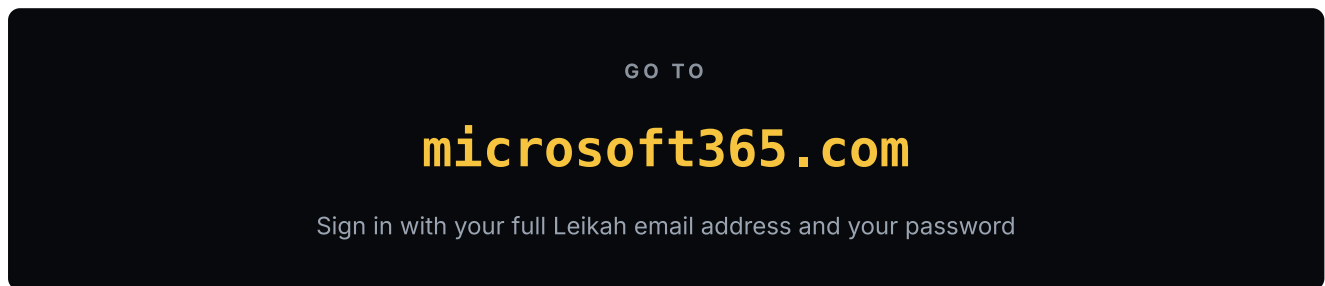
BANKING

Never change a supplier's banking details on the strength of an email, however convincing it looks. Always telephone the supplier on a number you already hold and confirm the change verbally. This one rule prevents the most expensive fraud that hits businesses of your size.

— ACCESS

Signing in

One address, one password, everything behind it.



- 01 Open `microsoft365.com` in any browser.
- 02 Enter your full address, for example `reception@leikahgroup.co.za` . Not just the first part.
- 03 Enter your password, then approve the prompt on your phone.
- 04 You arrive at your dashboard. Click the nine dot grid in the top left for any application.

Bookmarks worth keeping

FOR	ADDRESS
Everything	<code>microsoft365.com</code>
Email only	<code>outlook.office.com</code>
Files only	<code>onedrive.com</code>

On your phone

Install **Outlook** from your app store and sign in with the same details. This is worth doing on the first day, because it is what turns email into something answered within minutes rather than at the end of a shift. **Teams** and **OneDrive** have their own apps and work the same way.

**GOOD TO
KNOW**

The Office applications run in your browser with nothing to install. Whether you can also install Word and Excel onto a computer depends on which subscription you hold, so ask before buying anything.

BEST PRACTICE

Ten habits worth building

None of these take effort once they are routine, and each one removes a problem you would otherwise meet eventually.

-
- 01 Keep your password private.** Not on a note under the keyboard, and not shared with a colleague. Shared mailbox access exists so that nobody ever needs somebody else's password.

 - 02 Never share a verification code.** No legitimate person will ever ask for one. Anybody who does is trying to get into your account.

 - 03 Lock your computer when you walk away.** Windows key and L. On a Mac, Control, Command and Q.

 - 04 Save to OneDrive, not the desktop.** A file on a desktop exists once. A file in OneDrive exists everywhere and can be recovered.

 - 05 Reply from the right address.** Company enquiries go out from the shared mailbox they arrived in, not from your personal address.

 - 06 Check the junk folder weekly.** Filters are good, not perfect. A genuine enquiry lands there occasionally and is worth two minutes of your week.

 - 07 Use folders.** One per client or per site. Ten minutes of setup saves an hour a month of searching.

 - 08 Empty deleted items now and then.** Check it first, because the wrong thing does end up there.

 - 09 Keep your contact details current.** Your recovery phone number is what gets you back in when a phone is lost or replaced.

 - 10 Tell us when someone leaves.** Access should be removed the same day, not the same month.
-

SUPPORT

We are one message away

You do not need to work anything out on your own. If something is not behaving, ask.

Contact us about

EMAIL AND ACCOUNTS

- Mail not sending or arriving
- Password resets and lock outs
- Shared mailbox access
- A new staff member or mailbox

PLATFORM AND FILES

- OneDrive and SharePoint
- Permissions and access changes
- Suspicious or phishing email
- General IT support

 ISM Digital Solutions

YOUR MICROSOFT 365 PARTNER

PHONE AND WHATSAPP

082 802 9688

EMAIL

sirius.ascent@gmail.com